

# QUENTON HORTON

Cloud Support Engineer | AWS · Terraform · Linux | Active Public Trust  
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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

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Operations support professional with 2+ years monitoring mission-critical satellite data infrastructure at NOAA — triaging threshold exceptions, isolating faults, and coordinating incident response across five ground-system programs and international meteorological partners. Shift lead recognized for elevating team performance in high-stakes production environments. Builds and operates AWS infrastructure as code (IaC) with Terraform: provisioned a multi-tier VPC with layered security, load balancing, and observability; automated deployments with a CI/CD (continuous integration/continuous deployment) pipeline using GitHub Actions and OIDC; and diagnosed and documented eight production-style failures across networking, IAM, DNS, and system layers. Pursuing the AWS Solutions Architect Associate certification.

## CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

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- **Cloud & IaC:** AWS (SAA in progress) — S3, CloudFront, Lambda, DynamoDB, API Gateway, IAM, VPC (public/private subnets, route tables, security groups, NACLs, NAT, Internet Gateway, Gateway endpoints), ALB, CloudWatch, SNS, Route 53, ACM, CloudShell/CLI; Terraform (infrastructure as code, remote state, drift detection); IAM Identity Center (SSO)
- **CI/CD & Automation:** CI/CD (continuous integration/continuous deployment) with GitHub Actions; OIDC role-based authentication (no long-lived keys); remote state backend (S3 with native state locking); automated plan/apply and deploy pipelines
- **Networking:** TCP/IP, DNS, subnetting/CIDR, routing, load balancing, security groups vs. NACLs, distributed-systems concepts
- **Monitoring & Observability:** CloudWatch, Kibana / ELK Stack, Nagios, SolarWinds; JIRA (incident ticketing and escalation workflows)
- **Operations:** Incident triage, fault isolation, root-cause analysis, escalation to Tier 2, SLA management, technical documentation
- **Scripting & Tools:** Bash (production), Python (debugging), Git/GitHub, VMware, Cisco Packet Tracer
- **Environment:** NCCF (NOAA Common Cloud Framework) — production cloud operations

## PROJECTS

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### AWS Break/Fix Lab — Infrastructure as Code & Incident Response

AWS · Terraform · 2026

[github.com/Quenton-Horton/aws-breakfix-lab](https://github.com/Quenton-Horton/aws-breakfix-lab)

- Provisioned a multi-tier AWS VPC entirely in Terraform: public and private subnets across two Availability Zones, Application Load Balancer, NAT gateway, three layered security groups (ALB / app / data), scoped IAM instance role, DynamoDB with a Gateway VPC endpoint, and CloudWatch alarms wired to SNS alerting.
- Authenticated through IAM Identity Center (SSO) using a scoped admin identity with no long-lived access keys; protected the root account with MFA — a least-privilege access model applied from the ground up.
- Diagnosed and documented eight production-style incidents — SSH/SSM connectivity, IAM permission failure, ALB unhealthy targets, private-subnet routing loss, DNS resolution failure, disk exhaustion, CPU saturation, and security-group drift — each with a Symptom / Isolation Path / Root Cause / Resolution / Prevention write-up.
- Used *terraform plan* as a drift-detection and audit control: identified unauthorized security-group changes as configuration drift and remediated by re-converging on declared state.

### Cloud Resume Challenge — Full-Stack Serverless Web Application

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- Deployed a serverless site on private Amazon S3 served globally over HTTPS through a CloudFront CDN, with the bucket locked to the CDN via CloudFront Origin Access Control (OAC) and a least-privilege bucket policy; wired a custom domain with Route 53 and an ACM TLS certificate.
- Built a visitor counter with a Python Lambda function performing an atomic DynamoDB update, exposed through an HTTP API Gateway endpoint with CORS-enabled integration.
- Built a CI/CD (continuous integration/continuous deployment) pipeline with GitHub Actions: frontend pushes auto-sync to S3 and invalidate CloudFront; infrastructure changes run terraform plan on pull request and apply on merge — authenticated via OIDC with no stored credentials.
- Migrated Terraform state to a remote S3 backend with native state locking, enabling safe automated applies from CI.

- Hardened the Lambda execution role from the broad AmazonDynamoDBFullAccess managed policy (~80 permissions across a dozen services) to an inline policy scoped to a single action on a single table ARN — reducing the role to exactly one permission.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### FedGeek / ERT — NOAA Affiliate

Washington, D.C. | March 2024 – Present

#### Operations Support Specialist — ESPC Help Desk

- Monitor satellite data ingestion across five ground-system programs (GOES, JPSS, EUMETSAT, DMSP, JMA) within NCCF, verifying on-orbit arrivals and flagging threshold exceptions for escalation.
- Triage and escalate data anomalies impacting service levels to Tier 2 engineers via JIRA, ensuring resolution within prescribed SLA windows.
- Maintain real-time operational awareness using Nagios, SolarWinds, and Kibana dashboards, supporting incident workflows across multiple technical teams.
- Coordinate with international meteorological partners — including EUMETSAT and JMA — to confirm data delivery for GCOM and other joint mission systems.
- Coordinated multi-team incident response during the Asheville facility outage, rerouting satellite data ingestion to Wallops Island while managing real-time communication across network, PDA, and product-delivery engineers and external UCAR customers.
- Selected as 1 of 4 from a 24-person team for L3Harris GeoCloud Compute System training; supporting active deployment of JIRA-based incident-ticketing workflows for GOES-18/19 data-impact users alongside stakeholders, ground-systems engineers, and software engineers.
- Promoted to shift lead; recognized with the 2025 Peer Award for elevating team performance and proactively securing resources for team readiness.
- Hold an active federal Public Trust position supporting mission-critical NOAA satellite data systems and controlled information.

## ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Mayor's Office of Community Relations & Services

Washington, D.C. | 2018 – 2019

#### Specialist

- Tracked and managed resident cases across District agencies using Salesforce; generated weekly reports and coordinated emergency response on a 24-hour basis.
- Served as frontline liaison between residents and government systems, translating complex needs into actionable escalations under time pressure.

### Learn and Serve International

Washington, D.C. | 2019 – 2021

#### Cohort Leader

- Led curriculum delivery for youth across public, charter, and private schools — in person and via Zoom — managing group dynamics and adapting content to varied audiences.

### United States Holocaust Memorial Museum

Washington, D.C. | 2006 – 2018

#### Project Advisor / Student Ambassador

- Advised program leadership on strategy and stakeholder engagement; led tours for VIPs, law enforcement, and international visitors.
- Trained tour guides and curated the Main Exhibition visitor experience; developed written narratives for historical accuracy and consistency.

## CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

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- CompTIA A+ | CompTIA Security+
- IBM Cybersecurity Analyst Professional Certificate (Coursera)
- AWS Solutions Architect Associate — In Progress

## EDUCATION

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University of the District of Columbia — Bachelor of Arts, English | GPA: 3.4